

Jamie Cheng

An Organizational Development and Program Coordination Professional
Dedicated to Community Engagement, Research, and Educational Impact

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Dear Hiring Committee,

When I came across the Community Outreach Program Coordinator role at the Trust Collaboratory and the Center for Smart Streetscapes, it felt like a strong match for the kind of work I gravitate toward. The position blends **community engagement and program coordination**, **social science research methods**, and **educational programming for high school students**—three threads that have run through most of my recent work.

I'm Jamie Cheng, an **Organizational Development and Program Management professional** with an MS in Applied Organizational Psychology from USC (3.95 GPA) and a BA in Psychology and Education Studies from Wesleyan University (4.00 GPA). My undergraduate years at Wesleyan included serving as a Student Engagement Ambassador at the Fries Center for Global Studies, where I planned International Education Week with university offices and student organizations, organized intercultural events, and conducted **MaxQda focus-group analysis** to surface barriers in study abroad participation. That experience gave me direct insight into how community-engaged research within an academic center actually runs.

Three areas where I think I'd contribute right away:

Community outreach and program coordination. At InGenius Prep, much of my day-to-day mirrors this role's administrative core—coordinating with partner organizations, vendors, and internal teams; managing event schedules and team meetings; and maintaining the communications cycle that keeps students, parents, and staff aligned. I've come to find real satisfaction in the rhythm of this work: stakeholder partnership, program logistics, and the small process improvements that compound over time.

Working with high school students. Outside InGenius, I've worked one-on-one with four high school students over two years as a part-time admissions counselor, walking them through career exploration, college list development, and essay writing—all four landed at reach or top-choice schools. Earlier, I designed and taught a 3-week English immersion curriculum for 12 high school students at EXPLO. I'm at my best when helping young people navigate big educational decisions, and when the work involves the kind of summer-institute and community-building programming this role calls for.

Social science research methods. Some of my most rewarding work has been turning stakeholder voice into something a team can actually act on—whether through survey analysis at NextGen Healthcare or MaxQda-driven focus-group research at the Fries Center that informed Study Abroad Office outreach. I'm comfortable across the methodology cycle—survey design, interviews, focus groups, and both qualitative and quantitative analysis—and I find this kind of work genuinely energizing.

I'd love the chance to contribute to the Trust Collaboratory and the Center for Smart Streetscapes—particularly to the community engagement and high school program work this role anchors. Thank you for considering my application; I'd welcome a conversation.

Sincerely,

Jamie Cheng